



City Council Meeting May 5th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VfeBc_evL_A
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Muncie Common Council Meeting Summary

Date: May 5, 2025

Meeting Type: Regular Monthly Meeting

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** Presiding Officer and Council President Harold Mason called the May 5, 2025 meeting of the Muncie Common Council to order at [00:00:37](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - *Present:* Council members Mr. McIntosh, Mr. B, Mr. Green, Mr. Dishman, Mr. Garrett, Miss Selvi, and President Harold Mason. (Note: Transcript roll call captures full board presence).
 - *Presiding Officer:* Council President Harold Mason.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by President Mason [00:00:41](#).
 - An invocation was delivered by Pastor Kevin Wood [00:01:13](#).

- **Citizens Recognition Award:** Mr. Jason Walker was honored as the Citizen of the Month for his 30-year career with the Delaware County Sheriff's Office, his local business ventures (First Choice Electric, daycares, Walker's Event Center), and his leadership in founding the Muncie-Delaware County Black Chamber of Commerce [00:02:14](#).
 - **Special Recognitions & Presentations:**
 - **ALS Awareness Month:** Councilman Gilligan recognized May as Lou Gehrig's Disease (ALS) Awareness Month, highlighting its devastating impacts and disproportionate effect on military veterans [00:07:37](#).
 - **Muncie Youth Leadership Presentation:** Mitch Isaacs, executive director of the Schaefer Leadership Academy, introduced student representatives (including student speaker Davana) who presented community survey results regarding ideas to beautify and improve connectivity around the Unity Bridge [00:08:54](#). Councilwoman Selby and Mitch Isaacs provided context regarding ongoing coordination with CSX railroad and local arts organizations for the bridge project [00:14:10](#).
 - **Indiana Run for the Fallen:** President Mason read a statement on behalf of Don Finnegan regarding the upcoming 11th annual Indiana Run for the Fallen (May 9<U+2013>11), noting that a stop at Muncie City Hall for Hero Marker #2083 is scheduled for Saturday, May 10, at approximately 12:45 PM [00:16:38](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Motion to approve prior meeting minutes was made by Councilman McIntyre and seconded by Councilman Green [00:19:21](#); approved by voice vote [00:19:41](#).
 - **Appointments to Boards & Commissions:** President Mason reported that WC Edwards, recently appointed to the Ethics Commission, had to step down due to medical reasons. Nominations/replacements (restricted to a registered Democrat to maintain balance) will be considered at the June meeting [00:19:52](#).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:22:56](#) **Ordinance 13-25:** An ordinance to vacate a portion of a certain public alley at 2619 West Ethel Avenue.
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* David Kals, attorney representing property owner Robert Huddleston.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* The attorney explained that the applicant owns both sides of the unimproved, grassy alley where old houses were previously torn down.
 - *Item-Specific Public Input:* None other than the applicant's attorney.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Motion to adopt made by Council Person Selby, seconded by Councilman Garrett [00:23:14](#). Passed unanimously by roll call vote [00:24:16](#).
- [00:24:40](#) **Ordinance 15-25:** An ordinance to amend the city's comprehensive zoning ordinance from R-3 Resident Zone to BD Variety Business Zone for premises located at

3300 North Milton Street.

- *Sponsor / Presenter:* Introduced by Councilman Green.
- *Deliberation Summary:* Brief procedural handling with no extensive debate.
- *Item-Specific Public Input:* None.
- *Action & Vote Disposition:* Motion to adopt made by Council Green, seconded by Councilman Macintosh [00:25:06](#). Passed unanimously by roll call vote [00:25:28](#).
- **00:24:50 Ordinance 16-25:** An ordinance amending Ordinance 33-24 fixing maximum salaries of appointed officers, employees, deputies, assistants, and departmental heads for 2025.
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Matt Waggley, Deputy Controller.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Deputy Controller Waggley clarified that opioid settlement funds require individual additional appropriations per year and do not roll over pre-appropriated like ARP funds. Council members also questioned a newly introduced "paver" position in the parks department; Waggley noted he would track down specific salary details while affirming that adopting the baseline salary ordinance would not be disrupted.
 - *Item-Specific Public Input:* None.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Motion to adopt made by Miss Selby, seconded by Councilman Garrett [00:26:14](#). Passed unanimously by roll call vote [00:32:01](#).
- **00:32:30 Ordinance 17-25:** An ordinance amending Chapter 159 (Floodplain Management) of the Muncie Code of Ordinances.
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Presented on behalf of Allan Wisley.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* A technical correction correcting a scrivener's error in the definition of "special flood hazard area" from "county" to "city."
 - *Item-Specific Public Input:* None.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Motion to introduce made by Council Person Selby, seconded by Councilman Garrett [00:32:47](#). Approved by Voice Vote [00:33:40](#).
- **00:33:52 Ordinance 18-25:** An ordinance amending Chapter 92 and Chapter 95 of the city code due to the anticipated opening of the skate park at Westside Park.
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Brad Marshall, Parks and Recreation Board President.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Marshall presented proposed park rules and skate park regulations. Council members discussed construction progress, safety signage, and the community enthusiasm surrounding the park's informal early usage. Council members requested a weekend ribbon-cutting ceremony.
 - *Item-Specific Public Input:* None.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Motion to introduce made by Councilman Green, seconded by Council Person Selby [00:34:16](#). Approved by Voice Vote [00:40:02](#).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:35:42 Bob Swintz:** Representing the London Witty Group, presented the Muncie Redevelopment Commission (RDC) annual report packet to the council for formal record entry and offered to field questions at subsequent meetings **00:40:35**.
- **00:42:17 Janetta Presley:** Resident of 1419 West 8th Street. Expressed deep frustration regarding severe trash accumulation and overgrowth along the fence line of an empty city-owned GM lot across from her home, noting that she and an elderly partner cleared 28 large bags of trash themselves.
- **00:45:42 Courtney Marsh:** Southside Neighborhood Representative and President. Invited council members and community members to upcoming neighborhood cleanups, highlighting the Southside cleanup scheduled for May 17th beginning at Frankie D's on East Memorial Drive.
- **00:49:24 Brian Shaw:** Resident of 600 East Washington Street. Announced his neighborhood association cleanup on May 17th and inquired about MRC property acquisitions and rent-to-own programs relative to potential developments in his neighborhood.
- **00:47:00 (Additional Council/Staff updates):** Councilwoman Selby highlighted upcoming neighborhood cleanups, specifically shouting out Morningside's cleanup scheduled for Saturday the 10th and praising the building commissioner's responsiveness.
- **00:51:39 Amy Duff:** Resident of 401 East Memorial Drive. Reported severe code violations, suspected heavy drug trafficking, and squatters occupying a vacant property at 13th and Elm Streets without utilities, expressing safety concerns for local children and noting an unburied animal carcass issue. Councilman Garrett agreed to meet with her immediately following the meeting to utilize his building department background to assist.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Announcements:** President Mason reminded citizens that city property tax installments for the spring are due by May 12th **00:60:41**.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following a motion **00:60:28**.